



2025–2026 Undergraduate Catalog



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Strategic and Security Studies (B.A.)



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120 hours

The Bachelor of Arts in Strategic and Security Studies is a comprehensive interdisciplinary degree program that offers students seven concentrations from which to select: Cybersecurity, Geospatial Intelligence, History, Intelligence, International Affairs, Language, or Military Science. Each concentration builds upon a foundation of language learning through the 2002 level in the Field of Study as well as additional foundational courses focusing on internationalization from different disciplinary perspectives.

The program of study is comprised of an 21 hour interdisciplinary Common Curriculum that focuses on Military History, Political Science, and Geography courses. Each of the seven concentrations require 21 credit hours. The Study Abroad/International Internship requirement is at least 6 credit hours. In addition, students need to take 9 credit hours of select Political Science and History courses as well as 6 hours of electives.

No grade below "C" will be acceptable in any Political Science or International Affairs course or any course in the major area for Political Science, Strategic & Security Studies, or International Affairs majors.

Core IMPACTS – 42 hours

Refer to [Core IMPACTS](#)

Institution: No exceptions

Mathematics: No exceptions

Citizenship: No exceptions

Humanities: No exceptions

Writing: No exceptions

STEM: No exceptions (Note: Students choosing the Geospatial Intelligence Concentration should select GISC 2011/L)

Social Sciences: No exceptions

Field of Study – 18 hours

- Modern Language 2001
- Modern Language 2002
- POLS 1101 – American Government
- POLS 2401 – Global Issues

Choose one:

- HIST 2850 – Modern Military History
- POLS 2101 – Introduction to Political Science

Choose one:

- GEOG 1101 – Introduction to Human Geography
- HIST 2000 – Historiography
- INTL 1001 – International Studies I
- INTL 2001 – International Studies II
- POLS 2601 – Introduction to Social Science Research Methods

Major Requirements – 60 hours

Common Curriculum - 30 hours

- GEOG 3010 – Military Geography
- HIST 3001 – American Military History
- HIST 3002 – War and Society
- POLS 3202 – Introduction to Strategic and Security Studies
- POLS 4202 – Comparative Security Issues
- POLS 4245 – US National Security
- POLS 4320 – International Relations Theory

Additional Requirements – 9 hours from the following courses:

- HIST 3890 – International Relations and Conflict
- HIST 4020 – History of Military Thought
- POLS 4204 – International Political Economy
- POLS 4240 – Asian Security
- POLS 4241 – Middle East Security
- POLS 4243 – Why Nations Fail
- POLS 4244 – Terrorism & Political Violence

- POLS 4250 – Special Topics: Security and Strategic Studies

Concentration - 21 hours

Cybersecurity

- CSCI 3050 – Information Security
- CSCI 3250 – Computer Security
- CSCI 3350 – Computer Forensics
- CSCI 4650 – Network Security

Select 3 hours from the following (not taken elsewhere):

- CRJU 4325 – Homeland Security
- CSCI 3xxx–4xxx
- MATH 3540 – Introduction to Cryptography

Select 6 hours from the following (not taken elsewhere):

- CRJU 4325 – Homeland Security
- CSCI 3xxx–4xxx
- CSCI 4900 – Independent Study
- CSCI 4910A – Internship in Computer Science
- CSCI 4910B – Internship in Computer Science
- CSCI 4910C – Internship in Computer Science
- INTL 3xxx–4xxx
- MATH 3540 – Introduction to Cryptography
- Modern Language 3xxx–4xxx

Geospatial Intelligence

- CRJU 3721 – Introduction to Intelligence or
- POLS 3721 – Introduction to Intelligence
- GISC 3011K – Cartography and Earth Measurement
- GISC 3337K – Mathematical Methods for Geospatial Science and Technology
- GISC 3800K – Geospatial Intelligence
- GISC 4350K – Remote Sensing of the Environment
- GISC 4800K – Geospatial Intelligence Capstone

Select one:

- GISC 2011 – Geographic Information Science and

- GISC 2011L – Geographic Information Science Lab
- GISC 3012K – Global Navigation Satellite Systems
- GISC 3021K – Geospatial Science and Technology

History

Select 3 hours from the following (not taken elsewhere):

- HIST 4160 – Studies in Military History
- HIST 4190 – Studies in U.S. Diplomatic History
- HIST 4320 – U.S./Latin American Relations
- HIST 4631 – Expansionism and Imperialism in East Asia
- HIST 4660 – Studies in the Vietnam War
- HIST 4212 – Fall of Rome, Birth of Europe

Select 6 hours from the following (not taken elsewhere):

- HIST 3450 – The Crusades
- HIST 3555 – Vietnam
- HIST 3650 – The Mongol Conquests
- HIST 3850 – Modern Revolutionary Movements
- HIST 3890 – International Relations and Conflict
- HIST 3891 – Counter Insurgency
- HIST 4160 – Studies in Military History
- HIST 4232 – Studies in World War I
- HIST 4320 – U.S./Latin American Relations
- HIST 4631 – Expansionism and Imperialism in East Asia
- HIST 4635 – Korea at the Center
- HIST 4660 – Studies in the Vietnam War
- HIST 4850 – Studies in Modern World Revolutions
- HIST 4860 – Studies in World War II
- HIST 4880 – Comparative Empires

Select 6 hours from the following (not taken elsewhere):

- HIST 3141 – Cold War America, 1945–1991
- HIST 3160 – War and Society in America
- HIST 3180 – The Civil War & Reconstruction
- HIST 3193 – Modern American Diplomacy
- HIST 3205 – Ancient Greece

- HIST 3210 – The Roman Republic
- HIST 3211 – Roman Empire
- HIST 3280 – History of Western Warfare
- HIST 3291 – European Diplomatic History 1919–1991
- HIST 3450 – The Crusades
- HIST 3555 – Vietnam
- HIST 3865 – The United States and World War II
- HIST 3890 – International Relations and Conflict
- HIST 4160 – Studies in Military History
- HIST 4161 – Studies in American Revolution
- HIST 4165 – Reconstruction
- HIST 4190 – Studies in U.S. Diplomatic History
- HIST 4212 – Fall of Rome, Birth of Europe
- HIST 4232 – Studies in World War I
- HIST 4320 – U.S./Latin American Relations
- HIST 4660 – Studies in the Vietnam War
- HIST 4860 – Studies in World War II
- HIST 4880 – Comparative Empires

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- HIST 3850 – Modern Revolutionary Movements
- HIST 3865 – The United States and World War II
- HIST 3890 – International Relations and Conflict
- HIST 3891 – Counter Insurgency
- HIST 4020 – History of Military Thought
- HIST 4160 – Studies in Military History

- HIST 4161 – Studies in American Revolution
- HIST 4165 – Reconstruction
- HIST 4190 – Studies in U.S. Diplomatic History
- HIST 4212 – Fall of Rome, Birth of Europe
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- HIST 4320 – U.S./Latin American Relations
- HIST 4631 – Expansionism and Imperialism in East Asia
- HIST 4635 – Korea at the Center
- HIST 4660 – Studies in the Vietnam War
- HIST 4850 – Studies in Modern World Revolutions
- HIST 4860 – Studies in World War II
- HIST 4880 – Comparative Empires
- HIST 4900 – Internship in History
- HIST 4901 – Internship in History II
- INTL 3xxx–4xxx

Intelligence

Select one from each pairing:

- CRJU 3721 – Introduction to Intelligence or
- POLS 3721 – Introduction to Intelligence
- CRJU 3722 – Fundamentals of Intelligence Analysis or
- POLS 3722 – Fundamentals of Intelligence Analysis
- CRJU 3723 – The Intelligence Cycle and Collection or
- POLS 3723 – The Intelligence Cycle and Collection
- CRJU 3724 – U.S. Intelligence Community or
- POLS 3724 – U.S. Intelligence Community

Select 3 hours from the following (not taken elsewhere):

- POLS 4310 – Political Leadership
- CRJU 4722 – Intelligence and Counter Terrorism or
- POLS 4722 – Intelligence and Counter Terrorism
- CRJU 4723 – Intelligence Support for Homeland Security or
- POLS 4723 – Intelligence Support For Homeland Security
- CRJU 4724 – Special Topics in Intelligence Studies or
- POLS 4724 – Special Topics in Intelligence Studies (with a change in the course topic, a student may earn credit for either of these more than once)

Select 6 hours from the following (not taken elsewhere):

- INTL 3xxx-4xxx
- POLS 4220 – Spies and Statecraft
- POLS 4310 – Political Leadership
- POLS 4485A – Internship in Political Science
- POLS 4485B – Internship in Political Science
- POLS 4485C – Internship in Political Science
- CRJU 4722 – Intelligence and Counter Terrorism or
- POLS 4722 – Intelligence and Counter Terrorism
- CRJU 4723 – Intelligence Support for Homeland Security or
- POLS 4723 – Intelligence Support For Homeland Security
- CRJU 4724 – Special Topics in Intelligence Studies or
- POLS 4724 – Special Topics in Intelligence Studies (with a change in the course topic, a student may earn credit for either of these more than once)

International Affairs

- POLS 4201 – Comparative Government
- POLS 32xx-42xx
- POLS 32xx-42xx

Select one:

- POLS 3204 – International Organization
- POLS 3205 – International Law

Select one:

- POLS 4204 – International Political Economy
- POLS 4210 – Politics of Development

Select 6 hours from the following (not taken elsewhere):

- INTL 3xxx-4xxx
- POLS 32xx-42xx
- POLS 4485A – Internship in Political Science
- POLS 4485B – Internship in Political Science
- POLS 4485C – Internship in Political Science
- POLS 4590 – Special Topics in Political Science

Language

- Modern Language 3001

- Modern Language 3002
- Modern Language 3xxx-4xxx
- Modern Language 3xxx-4xxx
- Modern Language 3xxx-4xxx
- Modern Language 3xxx-4xxx or INTL 3xxx-4xxx
- Modern Language 3xxx-4xxx or INTL 3xxx-4xxx

Military Science

- MILS 3xxx-4xxx (with the exception of MILS 3005/3105/4005/4105)
- MILS 3xxx-4xxx (with the exception of MILS 3005/3105/4005/4105)
- Modern Language 3xxx-4xxx, HIST 3xxx-4xxx, INTL 3xxx-4xxx, POLS 3xxx-4xxx, or MILS 3xxx-4xxx (with the exception of MILS 3005/3105/4005/4105)
- Modern Language 3xxx-4xxx, HIST 3xxx-4xxx, INTL 3xxx-4xxx, POLS 3xxx-4xxx, or MILS 3xxx-4xxx (with the exception of MILS 3005/3105/4005/4105)

Select three:

- HIST 3141 – Cold War America, 1945–1991
- HIST 4020 – History of Military Thought
- HIST 4160 – Studies in Military History
- HIST 4232 – Studies in World War I
- HIST 4860 – Studies in World War II
- MILS 3200 – Foundations of Military Theory
- PHIL 3210 – The Ethics of Leadership
- POLS 3245 – Comparative Defense Policy
- POLS 4310 – Political Leadership

Study Abroad/International Internship - 6 hours (3 of which are applied elsewhere in the student's plan of study)

Policy governed by Department Head.

All SSST majors are required to complete at least 6 credit hours of an international internship and/or a study abroad program, 3 credit hours must be at the 3000 or 4000 level. A student's international internship must be coordinated within their concentration. A student's study abroad program can include courses from the following list of courses:

- 3xxx/4xxx non-English language course
- 3xxx/4xxx CRJU course
- 3xxx/4xxx HIST course
- 3xxx/4xxx INTL course
- 3xxx/4xxx MILS course

- 3xxx/4xxx POLS course

These courses are permissible for students as long as they are part of a recognized UNG-sanctioned study abroad program, or an international internship, which has been approved by the SSST coordinator. The Political Science & International Affairs Department Head can give exceptions to this policy at their discretion.

The Strategic and Security Studies program focuses on broad topics related to national security interests where international relations theory, intelligence and military power inform the construction of national security policy. This interdisciplinary program includes courses from the following areas: Intelligence, Geospatial Intelligence, Military Science, Critical Languages, History, International Affairs and Cyber-Security. Through this interdisciplinary program students will be introduced to various aspects of security and will have the opportunity to specialize in one of the seven areas of concentration for the degree. As part of this program students are expected to participate in a study abroad experience of at least 25 days in country generating at least 6 hours of academic credit or an international internship of 240 work hours in country to satisfy the international experiential requirement of the SSST major.

Electives - 6 hours in any course

Other Requirements

- [US and Georgia History Requirements](#)
- [US and Georgia Constitution Requirements](#)
- [Regents' Skills Program Requirements](#)

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